



IS ANYTHING TOO HARD FOR GOD?

February 23–March 1: Genesis 18-23

Seventy-year-old Ugandan woman gives birth to twins - hospital

1 December 2023

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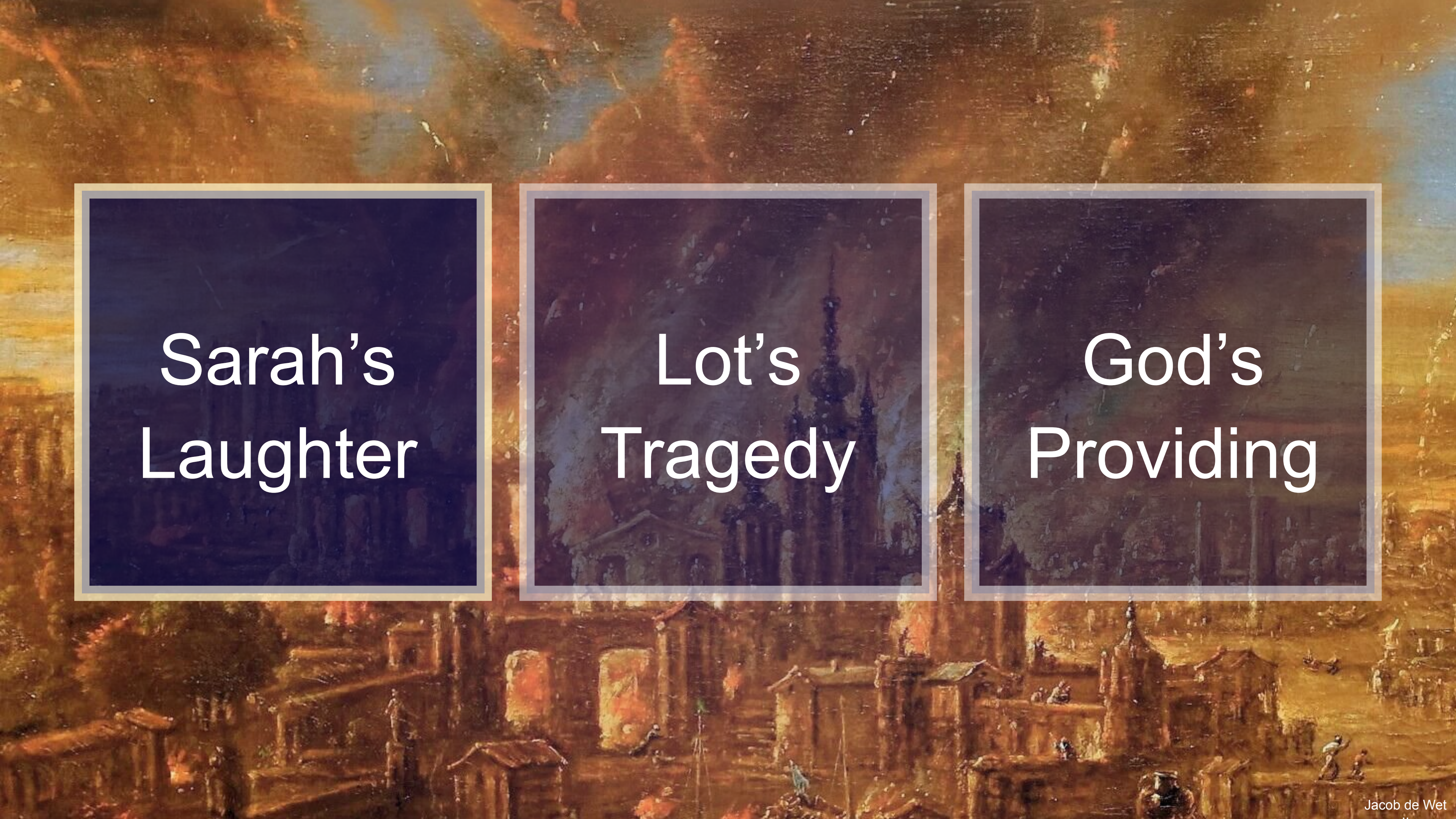
Danai Nesta Kupemba
BBC News



The Ugandan fertility clinic said Safina Namukwaya had become Africa's oldest mother at the age of 70

A 70-year-old woman has given birth to twins following IVF treatment, a hospital in Uganda has said.

Safina Namukwaya delivered a boy and a girl via caesarean at a fertility centre in the capital, Kampala.

The background is a detailed oil painting depicting the biblical story of the destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah. The scene shows a city in flames, with thick smoke rising into a dark, stormy sky. In the foreground, the ruins of the city are visible, with people fleeing and animals running. The overall tone is dramatic and apocalyptic.

Sarah's
Laughter

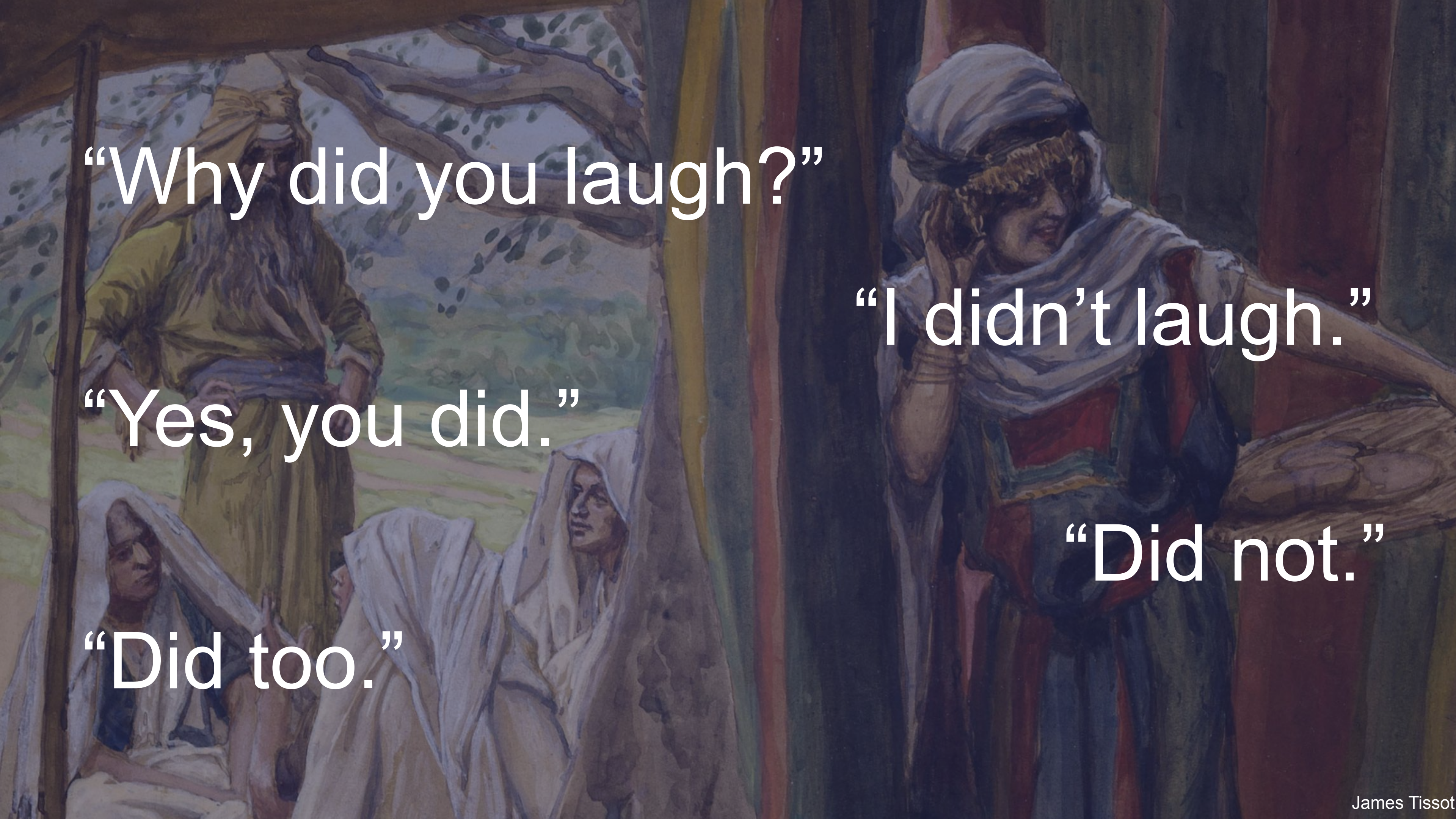
Lot's
Tragedy

God's
Providing

“Then the LORD said to Abraham, ‘Why did Sarah laugh and say, ‘Will I really have a child, now that I am old?’ ‘After I am worn out and my lord is old, will I now have this pleasure?’”
Sarah was afraid, so she lied and said, ‘I did not laugh.’”

Genesis 18:12, NIV

Genesis 18:13-15, NIV



“Why did you laugh?”

“Yes, you did.”

“Did too.”

“I didn’t laugh.”

“Did not.”



“Is anything too hard
for the LORD?”

Genesis 18:14, NIV

Adonai Translated as “Lord”

YHWH Translated as “LORD”

Genesis 18

13 And the LORD said unto Abraham, Wherefore did Sarah ^alaugh, saying, Shall I of a surety bear a child, which am ^bold?

14 Is any thing too ^ahard for the LORD? At the time appointed I will return unto thee, according to the ^btime of life, and Sarah shall have a son.

THE LIVING CHRIST

THE TESTIMONY OF THE APOSTLES

THE CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST OF LATTER-DAY SAINTS

As we commemorate the birth of Jesus Christ two millennia ago, we offer our testimony of the reality of His matchless life and the infinite virtue of His great atoning sacrifice. None other has had so profound an influence upon all who have lived and will yet live upon the earth.

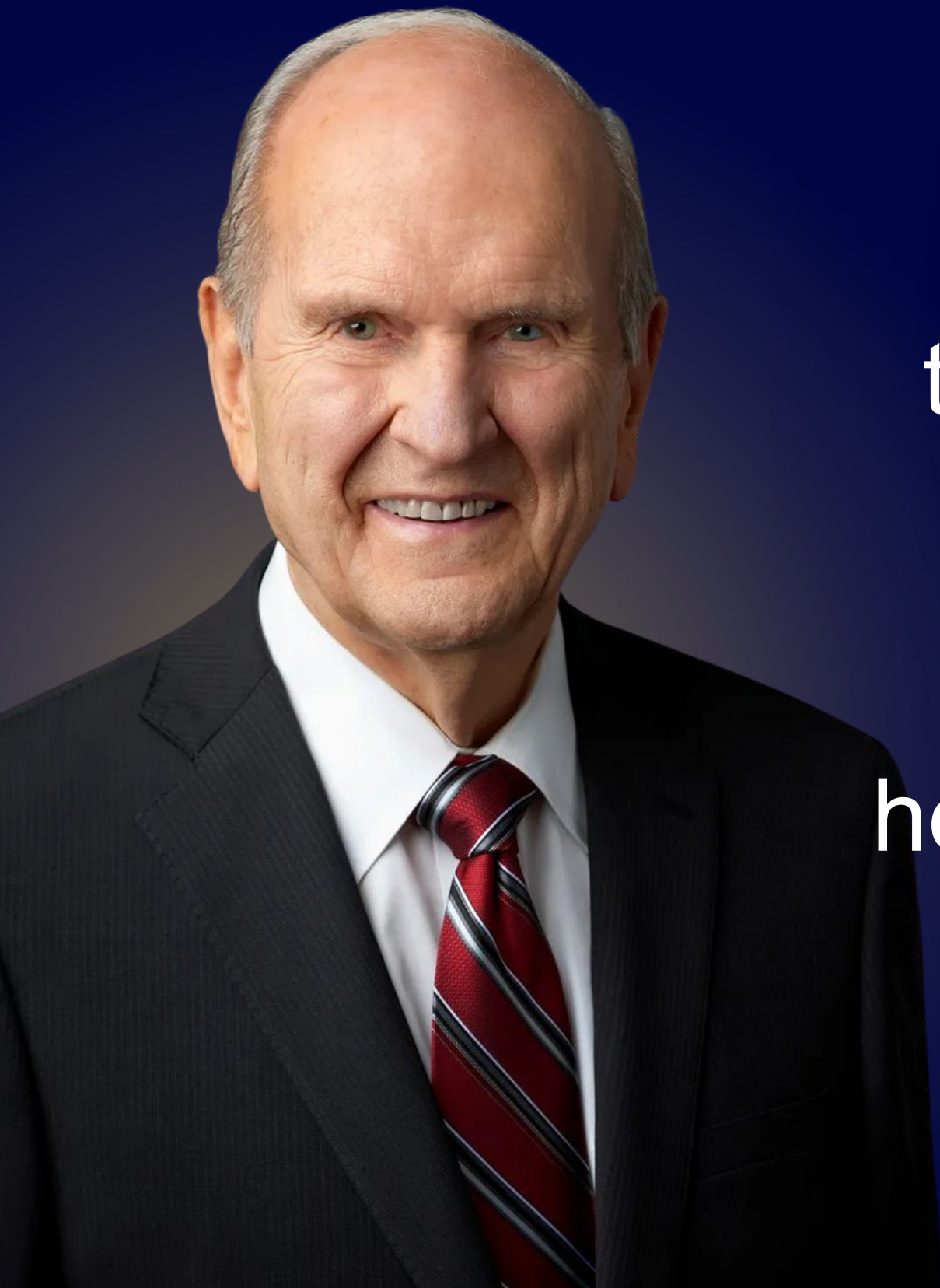
He was the Great Jehovah of the Old Testament, the Messiah of the New. Under the direction of His Father, He was the creator of the earth. “All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made” (John 1:3). Though sinless, He was baptized to fulfill all





“God has brought me
laughter, and everyone
who hears about this will
laugh with me.”

Genesis 21:6, NIV



“**Seek and expect miracles**...The Lord will bless you with miracles if you believe in Him, ‘doubting nothing.’ Do the spiritual work to seek miracles. Prayerfully ask God to help you exercise that kind of faith...Few things will accelerate your spiritual momentum more than realizing the Lord is helping you to move a mountain in your life.”

President Russell M. Nelson
Ensign, May 2022

“When everything was hopeless, Abraham [and Sarah] believed anyway, deciding to live not on the basis of what [they] saw [they] couldn’t do but on what God said He would do.”

(Romans 4:18, The Message)





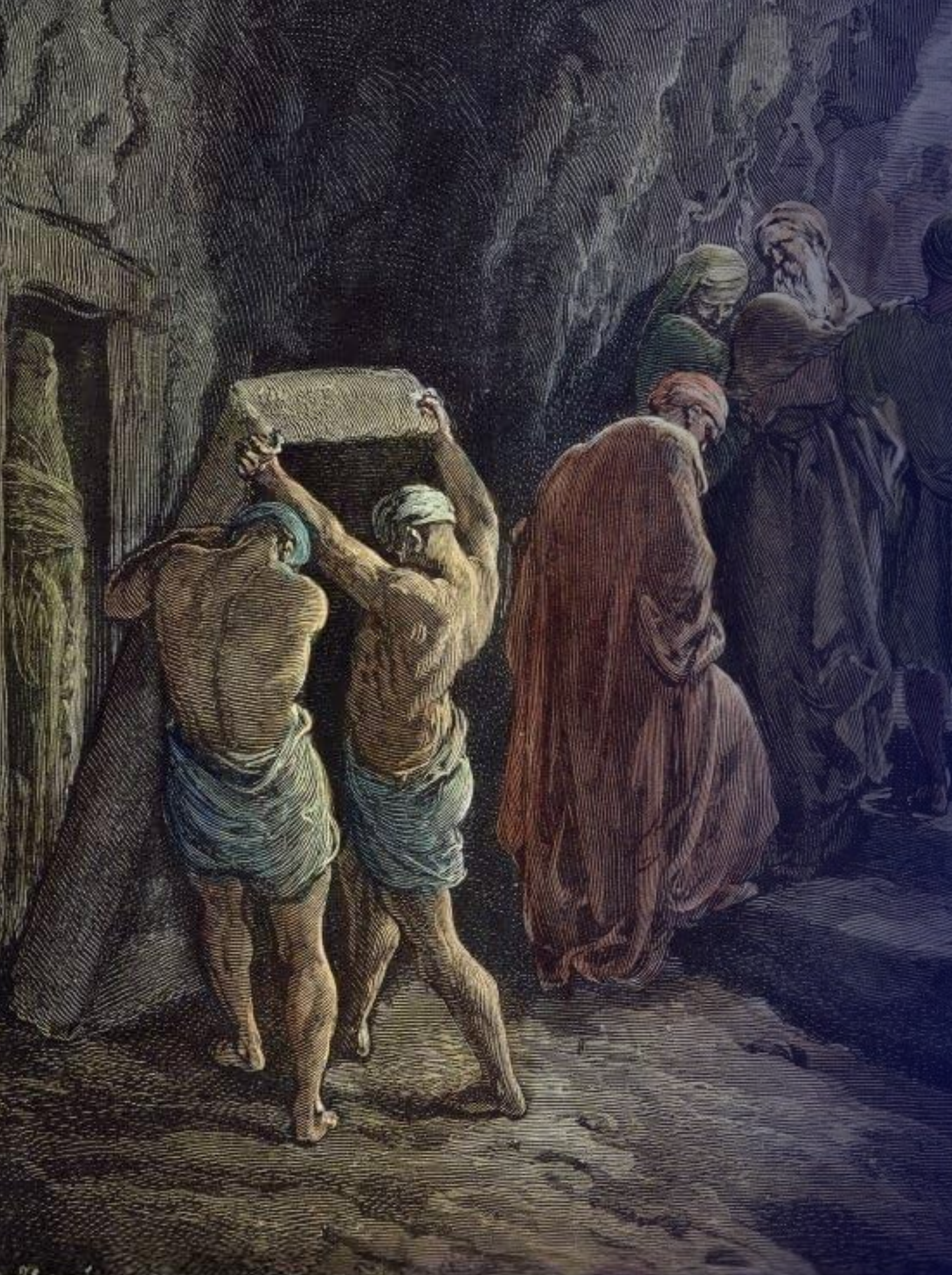
“By faith even Sarah, who was
past childbearing age, was
enabled to bear children
because **she considered him
faithful who had made
the promise.**”

Hebrews 11:11, NIV



“How will you conceive and
give birth to a son, and
since I am a virgin,
you are to call him
with Jesus?”

Luke 1:34, NIV



“By faith Abraham, when called to go to a place he would later receive as his inheritance, **they did not receive the things promised;** they only saw them and obeyed and went, **even though he did not know where he was going.** [Abraham and Sarah] were still foreigners by faith when they arrived on earth.”

Hebrews 11:8, 13, NIV

“Will you sweep
away the
righteous with the
wicked?”

Genesis 18:23, NIV

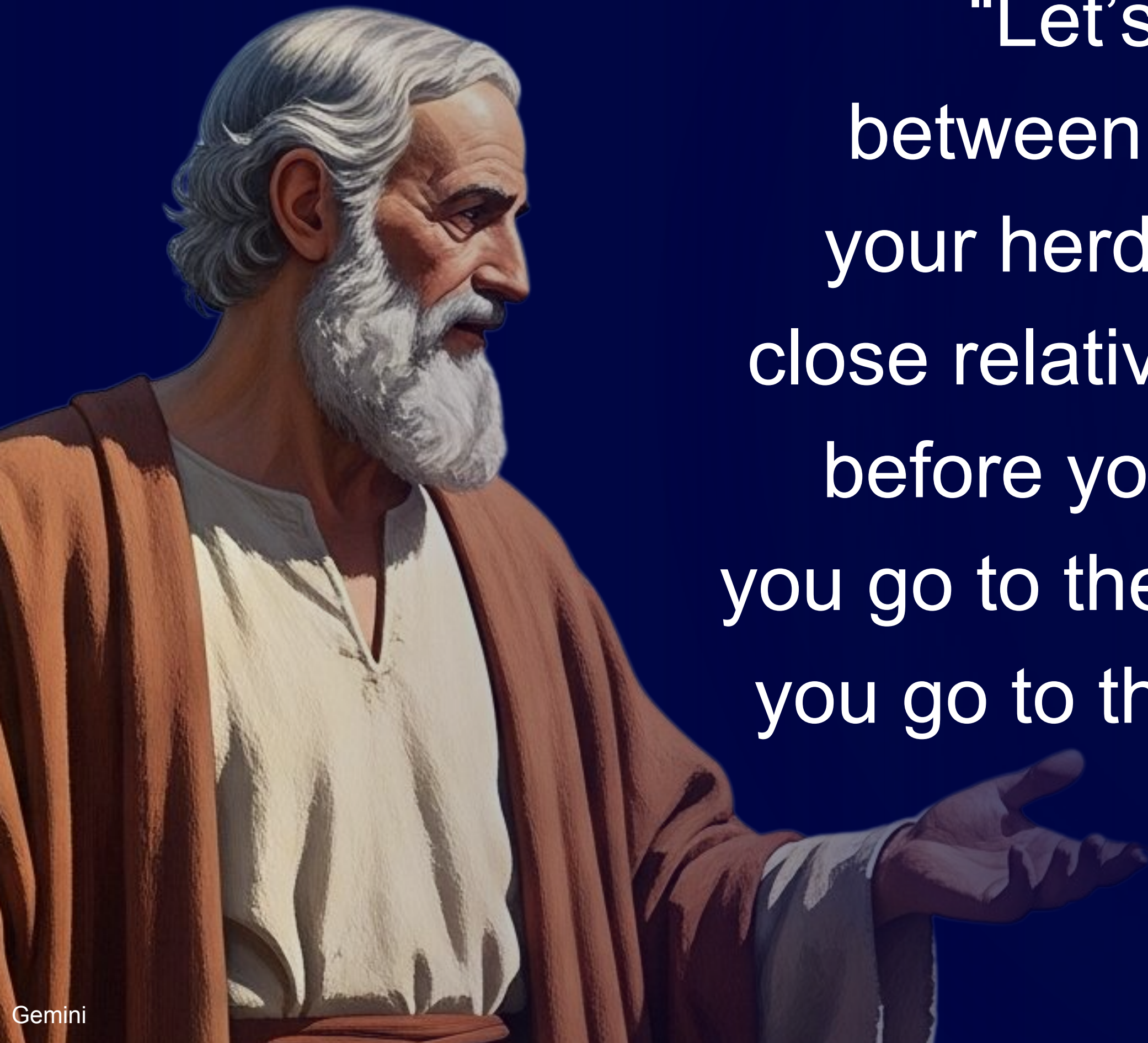




Sarah's
Laughter

Lot's
Tragedy

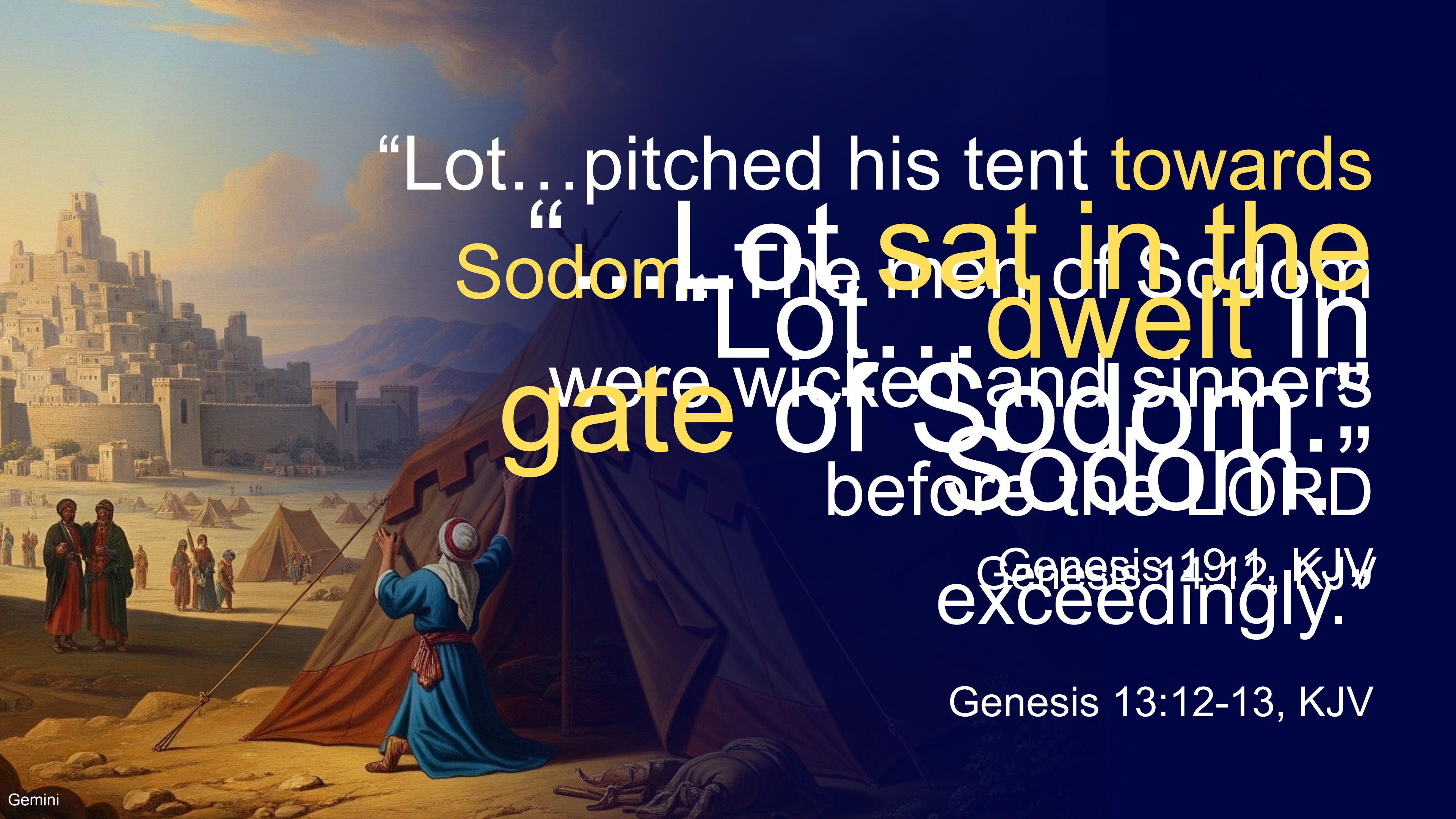
God's
Providing



“Let’s not have any quarreling between you and me, or between your herders and mine, for we are close relatives. Is not the whole land before you? Let’s part company. If you go to the left, I’ll go to the right; if you go to the right, I’ll go to the left.”

Genesis 13:8–9, NIV





“Lot...pitched his tent towards
Sodom. Lot sat in the
gate of Sodom.”
before the LORD

Genesis 19:1, KJV
exceedingly.

Genesis 13:12-13, KJV

Journal of Personality and Social Psychology Monograph Supplement

Volume 9, No. 2, Part 2

June 1968

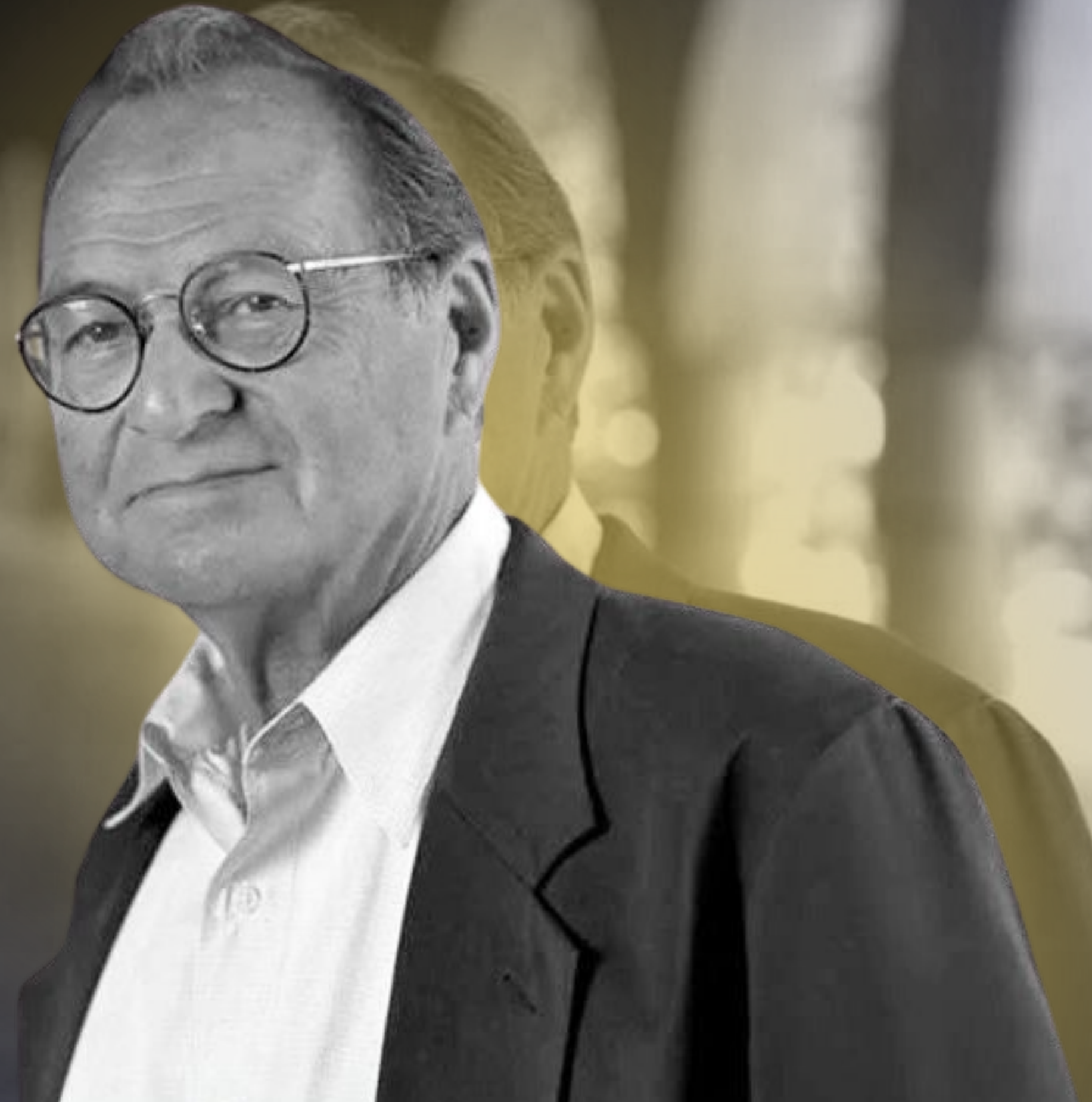
ATTITUDINAL EFFECTS OF MERE EXPOSURE¹

ROBERT B. ZAJONC
University of Michigan

The hypothesis is offered that mere repeated exposure of the individual to a stimulus object enhances his attitude toward it. By "mere" exposure is meant a condition making the stimulus accessible to the individual's perception. Support for the hypothesis consists of 4 types of evidence, presented and reviewed: (a) the correlation between affective connotation of words and word frequency; (b) the effect of experimentally manipulated frequency of exposure upon the affective connotation of nonsense words and symbols; (c) the correlation between word frequency and the attitude to their referents; (d) the effects of experimentally manipulated frequency of exposure on attitude. The relevance for the exposure-attitude hypothesis of the exploration theory and of the semantic satiation findings were examined.

On February 27, 1967, the Associated Press
telling story from Corvallis,

exposure" is meant a condition which just
makes the given stimulus accessible to the in-
dividual's perception.
the hypothesis seems to be in
(fami-





Gemini

“The eye is the lamp
of the body. If your
eyes are healthy, your
whole body will be full
of light.”

Matthew 6:22, NIV





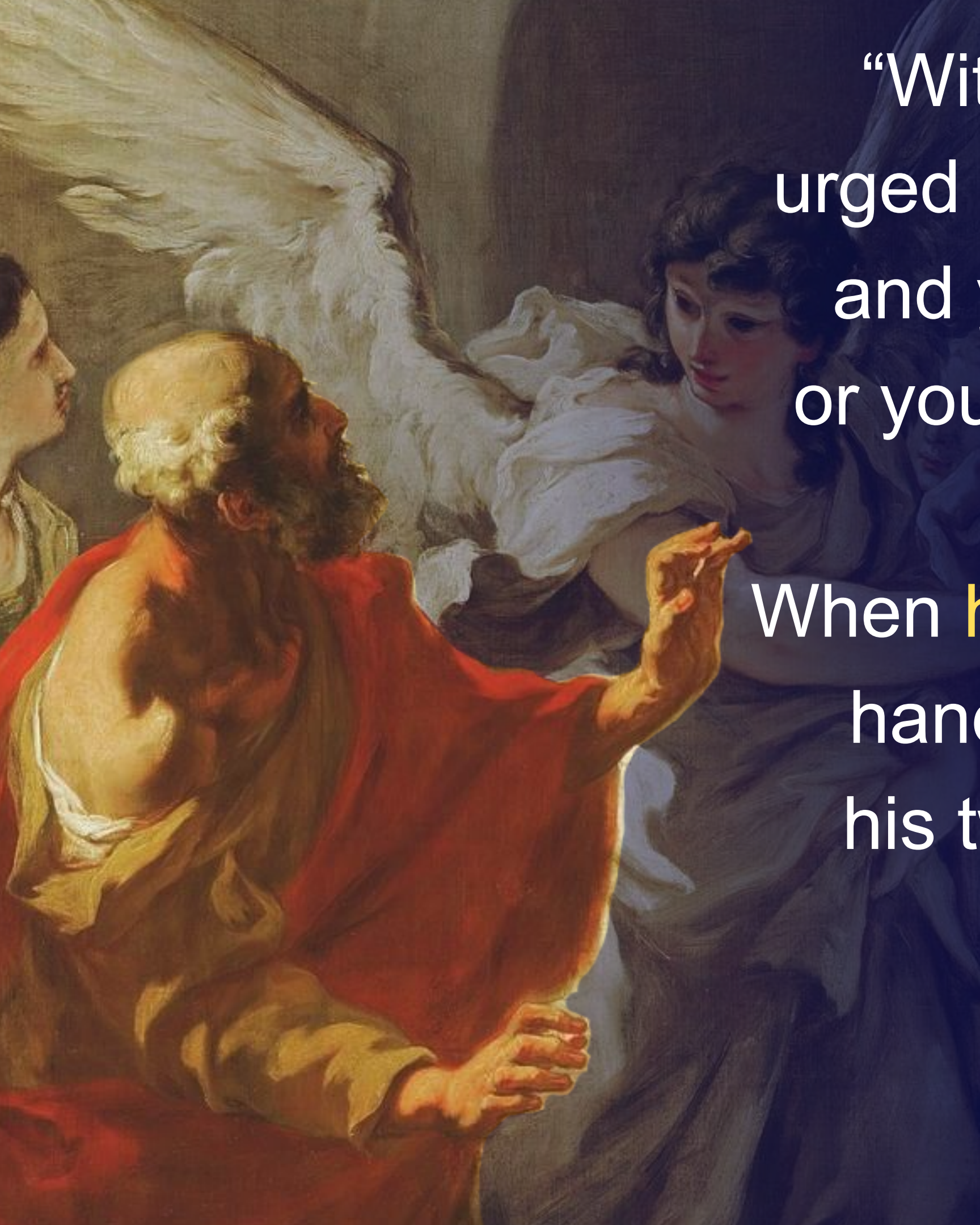
“[King Benjamin’s people]
pitched their tents
[with]...everyone having
their tents [facing]...
the temple.”

Mosiah 2:6



1. Be careful what you look at

2. Don't delay when God speaks



“With the coming of dawn, the angels urged Lot, saying, “**Hurry!** Take your wife and your two daughters who are here, or you will be swept away when the city is punished.

When **he hesitated**, the men grasped his hand and the hands of his wife and of his two daughters and led them safely out of the city.”

Genesis 19:15 -16, NIV



- Abraham **runs** to meet them

(Genesis 18:2)

- Abraham **hurries** into the tent to ask Sarah to prepare food

(Genesis 18:6)

- Abraham **runs** to the herd to prepare a calf

(Genesis 18:7)

“Flee, for your lives!
“Lot’s wife looked
Don’t look back, and don’t

Remember
stop only when you see the

plain. Free to the land of fairs or
LOTS WIFE.
you will
salt.

be swept away!”

Genesis 19:26, NIV

Genesis 19:26, NIV



“Apparently what was wrong with Lot’s wife was that she wasn’t just *looking* back; in her heart she wanted to *go* back.

So it isn’t just that she looked back; she looked back longingly.

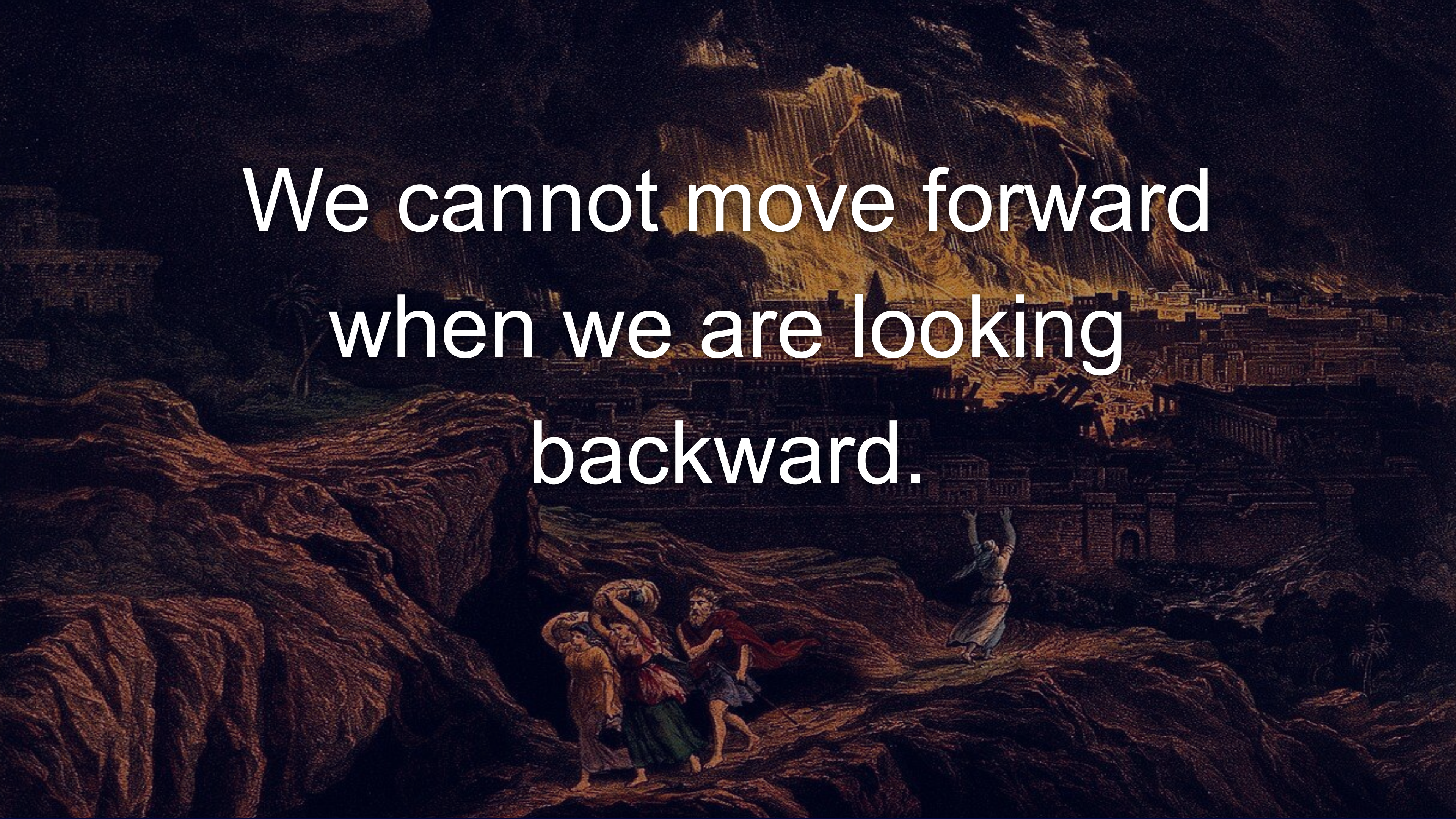
In short, **her attachment to the past outweighed her confidence in the future.”**

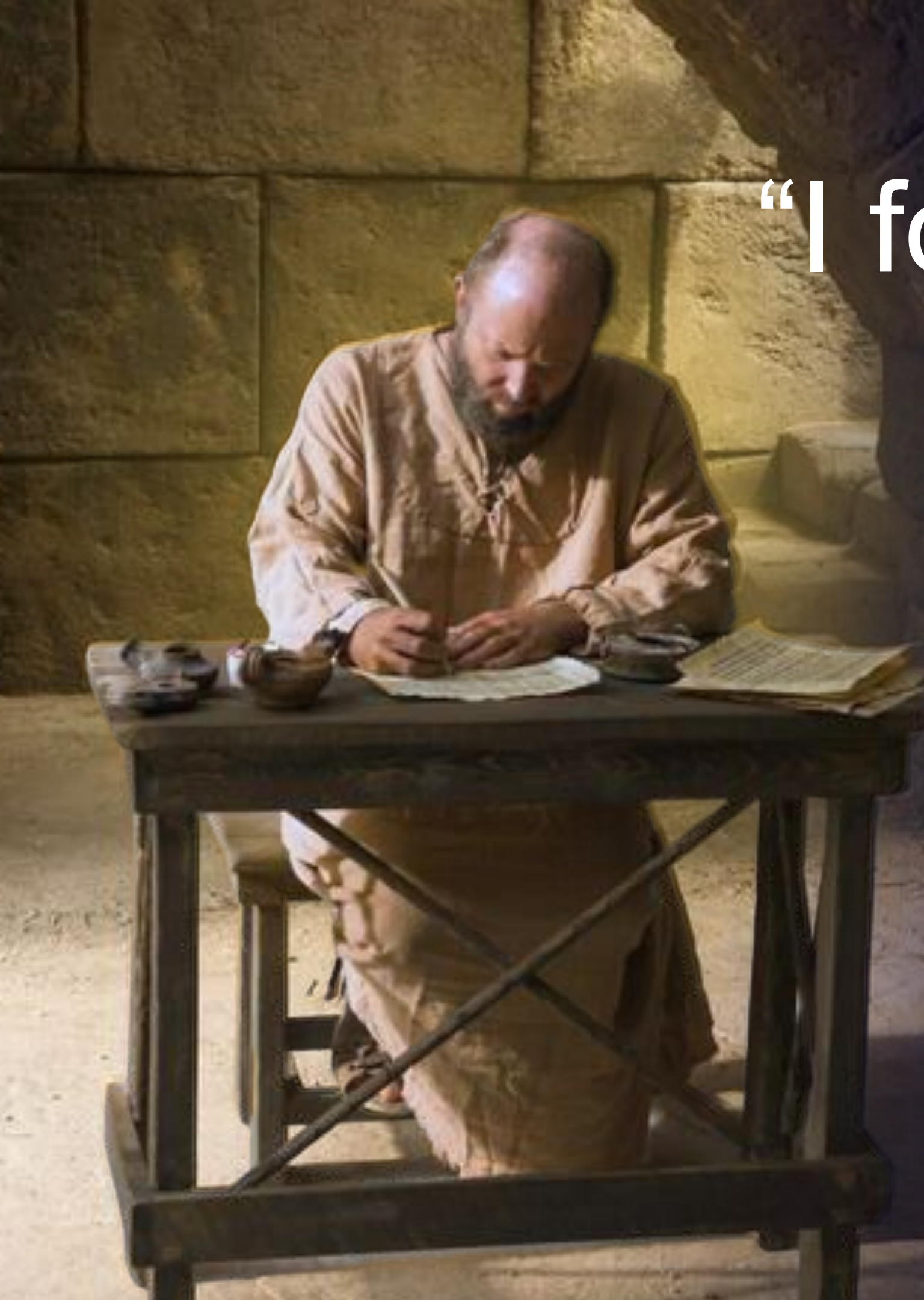
President Jeffrey R. Holland

“Remember Lot’s Wife,” Jan 2009



We cannot move forward
when we are looking
backward.



A man with a beard, wearing a brown robe, is seated at a wooden desk in a stone-walled room. He is focused on writing with a quill pen on a piece of parchment. On the desk are several inkwells and a stack of books. The room has a rustic, historical feel with stone walls and a simple wooden chair.

“I focus on this one thing:
Forgetting the past
and looking forward
to what lies ahead.”

Philippians 3:13, NLT

“You can remember just enough to avoid
“When Lot's wife was in her relationship with him, but,
“repeating the mistake, but the p. It is the essence of
honest effort is being made to progress the
the Book of Mormon, bury your
we are guilty of the greater sin if we keep
future. Faith builds on the past but never
weapons of war and leave them
longs to stay there. If a trust is made God
someday with their friends and is a reward
has overcome the traps and is a reward. Each of us
God doesn't care nearly as much about where
harder than to forgive. Forget: And
and have been as a reward for your most of
can be so hard on ourselves, often much
when it comes to mind again, forget
and with His help, where you are willing to go.”
good things to do so very (they grew up).”
it again. “the thing Lot's wife didn't get.”

President Jeffrey R. Holland

“Remember Lot's Wife,” Jan 2009

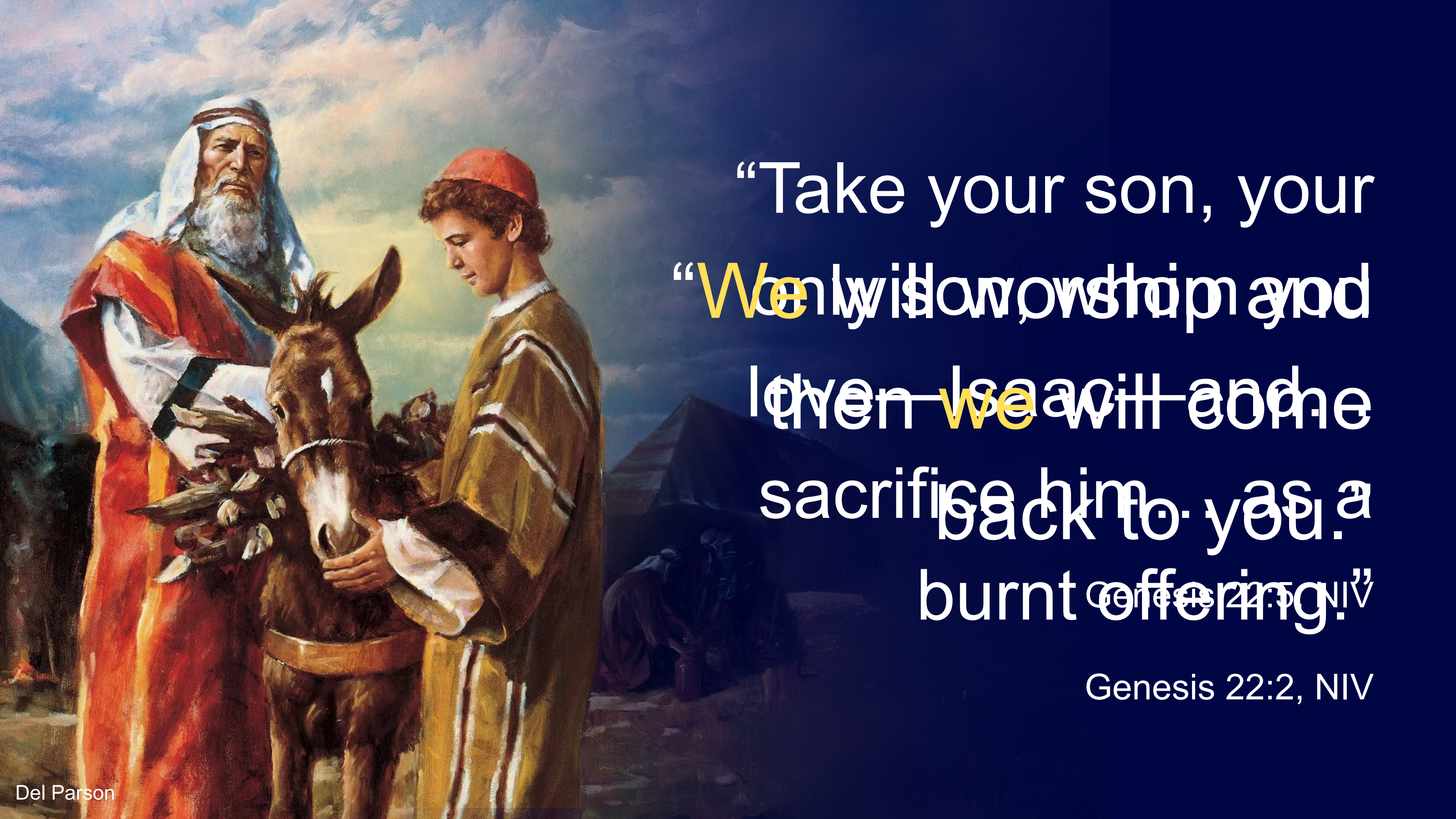




Sarah's
Laughter

Lot's
Tragedy

God's
Providing



“Take your son, your
only son, whom you
love—~~Isaac~~—and
sacrifice him to you as a
burnt offering.”

Genesis 22:2, NIV



“Father?... The fire
“**God himself will**
and wood are here,
provide the lamb
but where is the
for the burnt
lamb for the burnt
offering, my son?”
offering?”

Genesis 22:8, NIV
Genesis 22:5, NIV

“I’m sending you to
a promised land.”

“Where?”

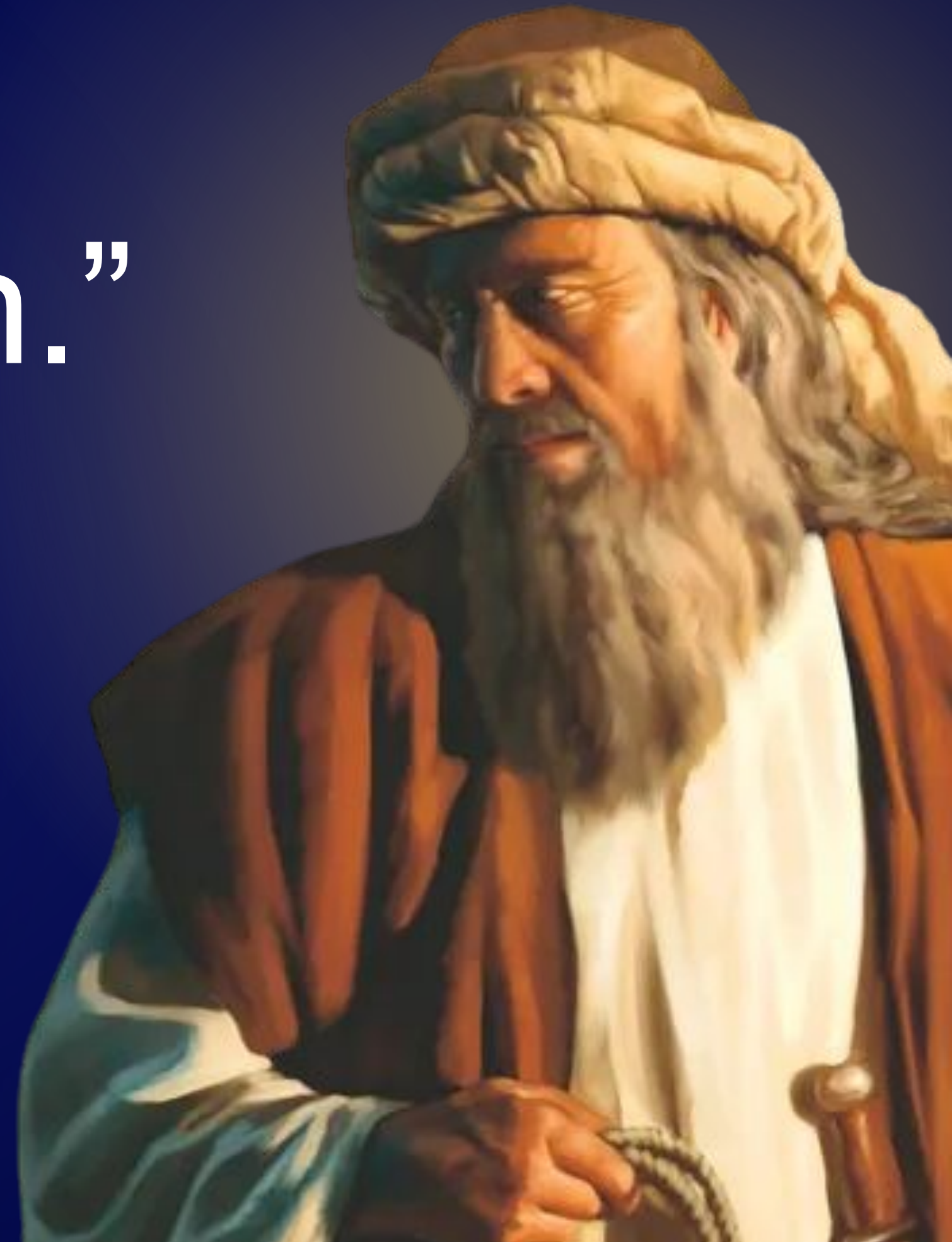
“I’ll tell you later.”



“You’ll have a son.”

“How?”

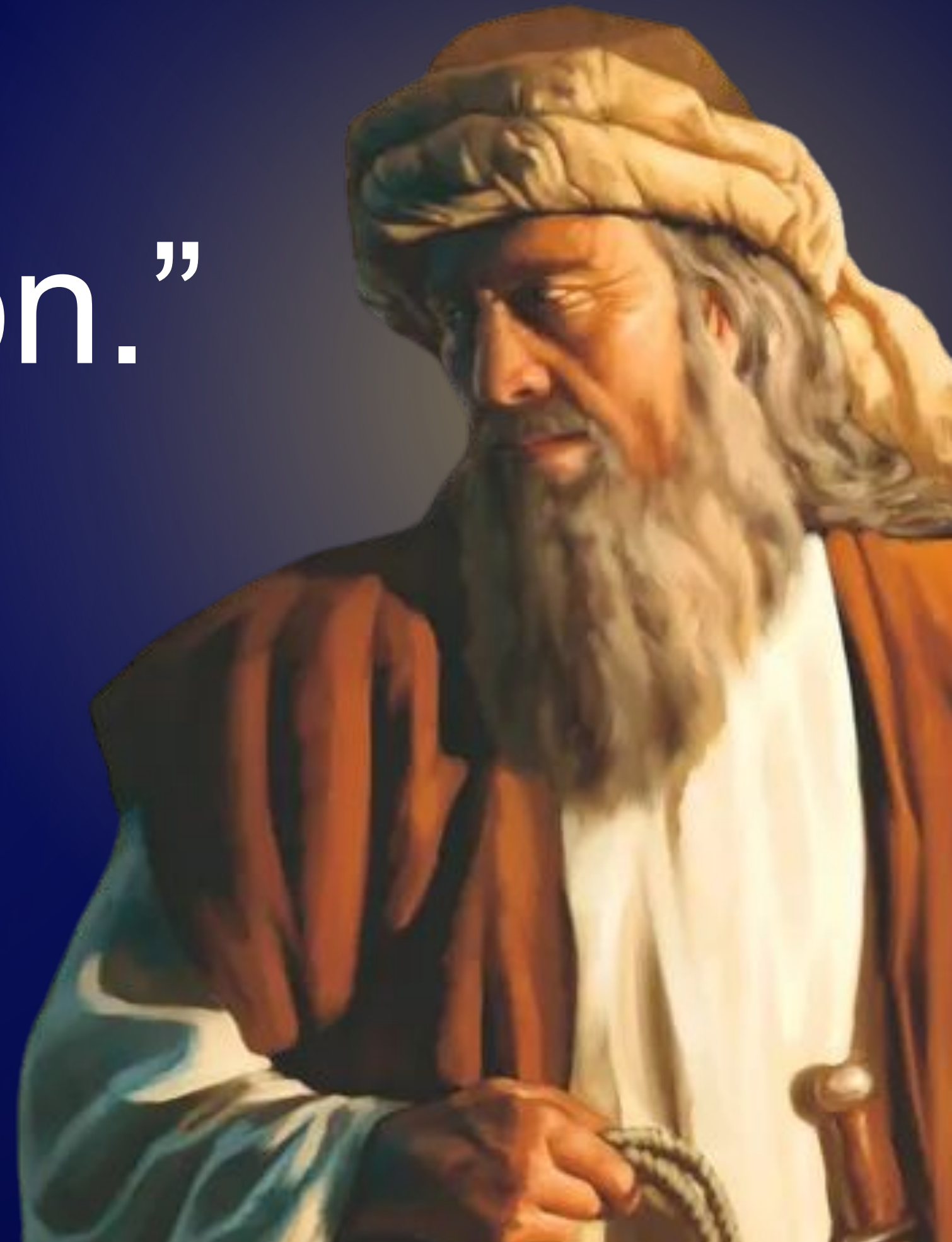
“I’ll tell you later.”

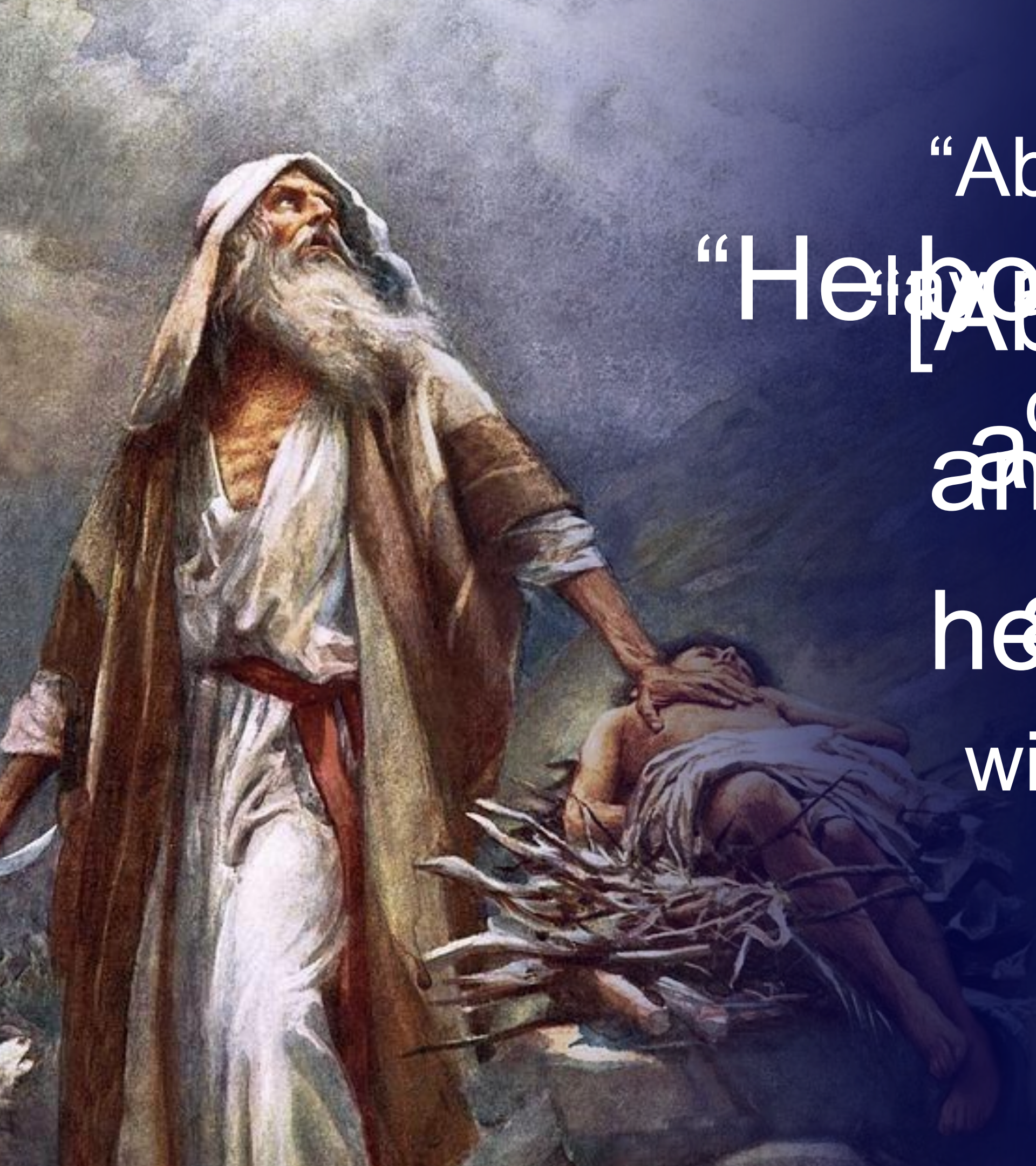


“Sacrifice your son.”

“Why?”

“I’ll tell you later.”





“Abraham! Abraham! Do not
harm your only son. I saw
[Abraham] looked up,
do anything to him. Now I
and there in a thicket
know that you fear God,
heaven and earth are not
withheld from me your son!
by its words.”
your **only son**.”

Genesis 22:11-13
Genesis 22:11–12, NIV

Typology

Typological Foreshadowing (God intended it)

Illustrative Parallels

(No clear divine or prophetic intent)

False Typology (No actual connection)



“Abraham
[offered]...up his son
Isaac, which is a
similitude of God and
his Only Begotten
Son.”

Jacob 4:5

A MIRACULOUS BIRTH

“Will I really have
a child, now that I
am **old**?”

Genesis 18:13

“How will this
be, since I am a
virgin?”

Luke 1:34

A FATHER OFFERS HIS BELOVED ONLY SON

“Take your son,
your **only son**,
whom you
love—Isaac”

Genesis 22:2, NIV

“For God so **loved**
the world that he
gave his one
and **only Son**”

John 3:16, NIV

CARRYING THE WOOD

“Abraham took the **wood** for the burnt offering and placed it on his son Isaac”

Genesis 22:6, NIV

“Carrying his own **cross**, [Jesus] went out to the place of the Skull”

John 19:17, NIV

A SUBSTITUTE SACRIFICE WAS PROVIDED

Isaac: A ram
caught in a thicket
is offered **in Isaac's
place**

Genesis 22:13

Jesus: Jesus
is the
substitute—
for us

John 1:29

1 Peter 1:18–19

OBEDIENT SONS, SUBMISSIVE TO THE FATHER'S WILL

Isaac could have resisted his elderly father, but submitted.

Genesis 22:9

“Father, if you are willing, take this cup from me; yet not my will, but yours be done.”

Luke 22:42, NIV

SIMILAR LOCATIONS

“God said... ‘Go to the **region of Moriah**. Sacrifice him there as a burnt offering on a mountain I will show you.’”

Genesis 22:2, NIV

“Solomon began to build the temple of the Lord in Jerusalem on **Mount Moriah**.”

2 Chronicles 3:1 NIV

THE FATHER DID NOT WITHHOLD HIS SON

“You **have not withheld** your son, your only son...”

Genesis 22:12, NIV

“He...**did not spare** his own Son, but gave him up for us all.”

Romans 8:32, NIV

“Sarah being silent [in the story of Isaac’s sacrifice is] a type of Mary. She is the mother of the son who’s going to be offered and she’s silent, just like Mary was at the cross... We have to think... about our mothers from the scriptures, what part they played and what they did and how important [they were, even if] we don’t hear [their] voice.”

Jo Ann Seely, Y Religion Podcast



“Abraham called the name of
that place **Jehovahjireh**...”

Genesis 22:14, KJV

“Abraham called that place
The LORD Will Provide.”

Genesis 22:14, NIV

“God himself will provide
the lamb.”

Genesis 22:8, NIV

Abraham didn't call the mount,
“I will do it, because I am awesome,”

he called it
“God will provide.”

Every challenge we face is
an opportunity to trust that
God will provide.





Nothing
is too hard
for the Lord



“He [Abraham] had been at the foot of Calvary the moment and Isaac went up the mountain, because Jesus died for you. You know what you did not withhold your Son, your only Son, whom you love, from me? What he would have done? He would have taken the sword and changed you. You have to, from the bottom of your heart, by the power of the Spirit, say, ‘Now I know! Now I know that you love me, because you gave your Son. You did not know he loved you like that?’”

Timothy J. Keller

“Real Faith and the Only Son”

